



RELOCATION GUIDE

Brisbane

Meanjin

A relocation guide for healthcare professionals and their families. The work, the neighbourhoods, the money and the weekends in Brisbane.

A river city in the sun. Two coasts an hour away.

Brisbane is Australia's third-largest city and its fastest-growing capital: two and a half million people on a looping river, with major teaching hospitals close to the centre and a dry, blue, 21-degree winter that people move here for. A family home within half an hour of the wards is still a realistic plan, and the beach is an easy drive in either direction.

~2.5M

people in Greater
Brisbane

21°

the average July day

1 hr

to the Gold or Sunshine
Coast

2032

Olympic and Paralympic
Games host

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Guides describe places, not employers. Hospitals are described rather than named, and salaries, visas and registration rules change, so we confirm the detail with you directly.

Why clinicians choose Brisbane

Brisbane gives you capital-city medicine without capital-city overheads: tertiary and quaternary work close to the centre, short commutes, and a lifestyle built around the outdoors.



If you're looking for the scale of Sydney or the cool-weather cafés of Melbourne, Brisbane may not be it. If you're drawn to sunshine, space for a family and serious clinical work with a home half an hour away, it could be a great choice.

Brisbane spent years being described as a stepping stone to Sydney. That picture is well out of date. Today it is a confident, fast-growing city of around two and a half million people, with a rebuilt riverside centre, a lively food and arts scene, and a decade of investment ahead of the 2032 Olympic and Paralympic Games.

For clinicians the draw is a genuine cluster: the state's major teaching and quaternary hospitals sit within a few kilometres of the river, with university partnerships and research institutes close by, and the growth corridors to the north and south carry some of the fastest-growing health demand in Australia. That means real choice about where and how you work.

Pay follows Queensland awards and enterprise agreements, broadly in the national range, and we will always walk you through the current agreement for your profession. The point is not that you earn more here. It is that the same career buys more life.

~30 min

inner suburb to a tertiary campus

commutes measured in twenties, not hours

2

coastlines within an hour
the Gold Coast south, the Sunshine Coast north

3rd

busiest international airport

about 20 minutes from the city by train

WHAT YOU GAIN

Depth close to home

Quaternary-level work and a house within half an hour of it: a combination that is increasingly rare in Australia's biggest cities.

A winter to look forward to

June to August is dry, still and blue, around 21 degrees by day. Outdoor tables, football and no heavy coat.

Weekends with range

A bay full of sand islands, rainforest in the ranges, and two very different beach cultures an hour either way.

GOOD TO KNOW

A warm, lively summer

December to March is hot and humid, with spectacular afternoon storms. Air conditioning, fans and early starts make it easy; the summer fruit makes it a pleasure.

A city that spreads out

The metro area is around 100 km across, so choosing your suburb with your workplace in mind pays off for years.

The beach is a short drive

The city sits on a river about 20 km inland. If you want sand at the end of the street, the Gold and Sunshine Coasts have their own hospitals too.



An honest word before you decide

Brisbane is one of the most sought-after destinations in Australia, and competition for healthcare roles here is very high. Securing a role, and particularly a sponsored role, is considerably more challenging in Brisbane than in regional Australia. We are not saying it's impossible, but we want to be honest with you: it can take longer, and it helps to be flexible. Many clinicians start in a regional city, where demand and sponsorship are often stronger, and move to Brisbane later with Australian experience behind them.



Weighing up your options?

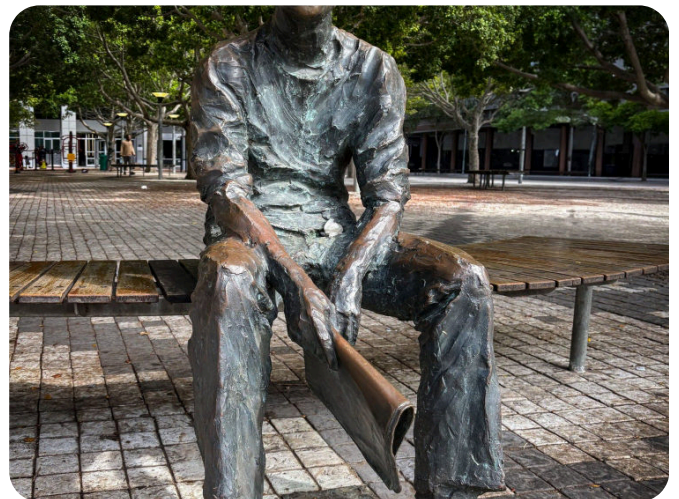
People often compare Brisbane with Sydney and Melbourne, for system scale and sub-specialty depth; with the Gold and Sunshine Coasts, for the beach at the door; and with Adelaide or Perth, for value. Brisbane usually offers the best balance of tertiary work, home and sunshine. We are happy to talk any of them through.



Old and new in the city centre: sandstone, palms and glass under a subtropical sky



South Bank after dark, looking across the river to the city



Shady plazas and public art: the city centre is made for strolling



Weekend brunch is a local institution



The surf is an easy drive in either direction



Family days at the beach, all year round

Brisbane at a glance

Brisbane is a river city built across ridges, which is why two suburbs four kilometres apart can feel like different towns. Ten minutes with a map before you choose a rental is time well spent.

The Brisbane River loops through everything and does the organising. The city centre sits inside one tight bend, with South Bank facing it across the water: the state gallery, museum and library, riverside gardens and a free swimming lagoon on the old Expo 88 site. Kangaroo Point's cliffs, the Story Bridge and the New Farm reach are all a few minutes away.

Around that, the inner ring runs four to six kilometres out in every direction, full of timber Queenslanders on stumps with wide verandahs. Beyond it the city stretches a long way: growth corridors north towards the Sunshine Coast and south towards the Gold Coast, the bayside suburbs facing Moreton Bay to the east, and Ipswich and the valleys to the west.

Summer

DEC – FEB

Warm to hot and humid, around 21–30°C, with afternoon storms that roll in and clear by evening. Mornings are when the city comes alive, and the mangoes and lychees arrive.

Autumn

MAR – MAY

Around 16–27°C, with the humidity easing week by week. Warm water, golden evenings and the start of outdoor season.

Winter

JUN – AUG

The season people move for: dry, still and sunny, around 10–21°C, cool enough at night for a jumper and perfect for markets, walks and football.

Spring

SEP – NOV

Around 15–27°C, with jacarandas turning whole streets purple in October and November and the warmth building towards summer.



Living with the weather

Make air conditioning, ceiling fans and cross-breezes part of your rental search; a well-designed Queenslander does half the work. Storm season (roughly November to March) can bring hail, flash flooding and the odd power cut, so check a property's flood history on the council's flood maps before you sign.



The Story Bridge, the city's best-loved landmark, from the riverbank



St Stephen's Cathedral, a Gothic Revival landmark among the city towers

Country and the clock

- ✓ Brisbane stands on the lands of the Turrbal and Jagera peoples. Meanjin, the name for the city area, is increasingly used alongside Brisbane, and Acknowledgement of Country opens meetings and events.
- ✓ Words you will hear in week one: the Queenslander (the classic timber house on stumps), the CityCat (the river ferry), the Valley (Fortitude Valley) and the Coast (Gold or Sunshine, depending on who you ask).
- ✓ Queensland does not observe daylight saving. In summer it is light from about 4.45am and dark by seven, so gyms, swims and coffee start early, and from October to April Brisbane is an hour behind Sydney and Melbourne.

Healthcare and work in Brisbane

Registration is national; hiring here is service by service. Brisbane's great strength is concentration: tertiary and quaternary medicine within a few kilometres of the river, and fast-growing demand in the corridors either side.

Queensland runs its public hospitals through sixteen regional hospital and health services. Several of them cover Greater Brisbane, split broadly between the inner city, the northern side and the southern side, with a statewide children's service alongside them that takes referrals from across Queensland and northern New South Wales.

Each service employs in its own right, so a job in Brisbane is really a job in one part of a metro area a hundred kilometres across, and moving between services later is a fresh application rather than a transfer. Around the public system sit a substantial private hospital sector, large private imaging and pathology providers, university-linked research institutes and Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander community-controlled health organisations.



Busy, collegial teams: the metro services recruit steadily across disciplines

BOTH BANKS OF THE RIVER

The inner city

The major teaching and quaternary campuses, a few kilometres from the CBD, with the state's most complex adult work and the statewide children's service.

ITS OWN SERVICE

The northern side

Secondary, tertiary and community services across the north, with growth pushing in from the corridor beyond.

ITS OWN SERVICE

The southern side

A large and still-growing catchment on the far bank from the inner-city cluster, with its own campuses.

TOWARDS BOTH COASTS

The growth corridors

Among the fastest-growing catchments in Australia, with new capacity coming on and steady recruitment behind it.

For a career, Brisbane is one of the few Australian cities where you can generally have both: quaternary-level work and a house within half an hour of it. Sub-specialty teams are deep enough for most fellowships; if your field is very narrow, ask us early and we will tell you how the local service fits.

The 2032 Games matter less as a sporting event than as a decade of committed investment in hospitals, transport and housing, much of it already under way. And beyond Brisbane, Queensland's regional and tropical services, from Toowoomba to Townsville and Cairns, offer tertiary-level medicine in remarkable settings. Brisbane is not classed as regional for skilled migration, which we will explain alongside your visa options.

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Working with Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities

Health services work in partnership with Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander community-controlled organisations, and Torres Strait Islander health is a significant part of the Queensland picture. Expect a cultural induction early on; a genuine willingness to learn is what matters.

Giving yourself the best chance in Brisbane

- ✓ Be open to more than one campus, service or shift pattern. The wider your search, the better your chances.
- ✓ Get your registration well under way early. Employers here often favour candidates who can start sooner.
- ✓ Keep a regional option alongside Brisbane. Regional cities often have stronger demand and are more able to sponsor, and Australian experience makes a later move to Brisbane much easier.
- ✓ Talk to us early, so we can give you a realistic picture for your profession and specialty.

What to ask at interview

- ☐ Which service and which campus? The same job title can mean quite different work across a metro area this size.
- ☐ What does the roster look like: shift patterns, penalties, on-call frequency and how gaps are covered?
- ☐ How much of my pay can I salary-package, and how do I set it up from day one?
- ☐ What funded CPD time and support is there, and does it include interstate conferences?
- ☐ What supervision and orientation is there in the first year for clinicians trained overseas?
- ☐ Is there staff parking at my shift times, and how do colleagues usually commute?
- ☐ Public, private or both: are there rights of private practice in my profession?



Skilled clinicians are warmly welcomed into growing teams



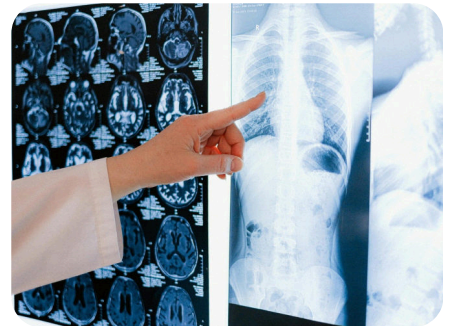
Paediatric and allied health work is a big part of the picture



Complex theatre work close to the city centre



Care in the community as well as on the wards



Imaging and diagnostics: a large public and private market

Where to live in Brisbane

In a metro area a hundred kilometres across, the suburb shapes the life. The good news is that Brisbane's inner ring is unusually generous: character homes a few kilometres from the major campuses, and great value a little further out.

~10 MIN · RIVER & RESTAURANTS

New Farm & Teneriffe

Converted woolstores, the city's best dining strip, riverside parks and a CityCat at the door. The polished inner-city choice.

~10–15 MIN · FAMILY QUEENSLANDERS

Wilston, Windsor & Ashgrove

Classic timber Queenslanders, well-regarded state schools and an easy run to the inner campuses.

~10 MIN · RIDGES & VIEWS

Paddington & Bardon

Steep, leafy streets, village cafés and antique shops, with views back to the city.

~10 MIN · FOOD & CHARACTER

West End & Highgate Hill

The city's most characterful pocket: Saturday markets, Greek and Vietnamese food and a bend of the river.

~15–20 MIN · INNER-SOUTH VALUE

Annerley, Moorooka & Tarragindi

Solid family homes, good buses and noticeably more space for your money than the inner north.

~20 MIN · FERRY & FAMILY

Bulimba & Hawthorne

Family-friendly riverside suburbs with a village high street and ferries into town.

~30 MIN · BAYSIDE

Wynnum & Manly

Esplanades on Moreton Bay, a relaxed pace, sailing clubs and more house for your money.

20–45 MIN · SPACE & VALUE

Indooroopilly, Kenmore & Ipswich

Big blocks and good schools in the west; further out, Ipswich is a city in its own right with the best-value housing in the metro area.

Plenty of clinicians choose a coast instead. The Gold Coast, an hour south, and the Sunshine Coast, an hour or so north, both have major hospitals of their own and the beach at the end of the street. They are genuine career bases in their own right; the one thing to avoid is a daily commute between a coast and the city.

Most people rent for the first six months while they get to know the city, then choose for the longer term once they know where they work and how they like to spend their weekends.



The Queenslander: timber, verandahs and shade, designed for this climate



Canal-side homes on the Gold Coast, an hour south: a coast is a popular choice too

Before you sign a lease

- ☐ Which side of the river is your campus, and does the commute cross the city at peak times?
- ☐ What do the council flood maps say about this exact address? Always worth a two-minute check here.
- ☐ Air conditioning, ceiling fans, cross-breezes: how will this house feel in February?
- ☐ Is it in the state-school catchment you need? Catchments run street by street.
- ☐ Is it near a train line, busway or ferry terminal? It can save you a second car.

Getting around Brisbane

Brisbane's transport runs along three excellent spines: rail, busway and river. Live close to one of them and getting to work is easy, inexpensive and often rather lovely.

TRANSLINK

go card & contactless

One system for trains, buses, ferries and the Gold Coast trams across south-east Queensland. Tap on with a go card or your bank card; Queensland has introduced flat 50-cent fares on Translink services.

RADIAL LINES

Rail

Lines run out through the suburbs to both coasts and Ipswich, plus the Airtrain to the terminals. Excellent if you live on a line.

BUS-ONLY ROADS

Busways

Dedicated busways with their own stations let buses skip the traffic: fast, frequent and the backbone of the inner south.

RIVER FERRIES

CityCats

Fast catamaran ferries are ordinary commuting here, and arguably the nicest twenty minutes of anyone's working day.

FROM THE CITY CENTRE TO...	ROUGHLY	HOW
The inner ring (New Farm, West End, Paddington)	5–15 min	Bus, ferry, bike
Brisbane Airport	~20 min	Airtrain or toll road
Bayside (Wynnum, Manly)	~30 min	Train
Ipswich	~40 min	Train
Gold Coast	~1 hr	Train then light rail, or drive
Sunshine Coast	~1 hr 15	Drive, or train to Nambour
Scenic Rim and the hinterland	1–1.5 hrs	Drive
Sydney	~90 min	Fly



City buses heading home at dusk: the busway network is the backbone of the inner south



The river is a commuting route too: CityCats and ferries link both banks

Brisbane is easy to drive by capital-city standards, with plenty of river crossings, though there are toll roads and tunnels (the airport link among them), so a toll account is worth setting up early. Australians drive on the left. The riverside bikeways, the Goodwill Bridge and the Riverwalk also make a pleasant commuting network for cyclists, especially in the cooler months.

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Worth planning for

Choose a home near a train line, busway or ferry terminal and Brisbane works beautifully without a daily drive; in between the spines, most households run a car. In storm season, never drive into floodwater, and get to know the route out of your suburb that stays dry.

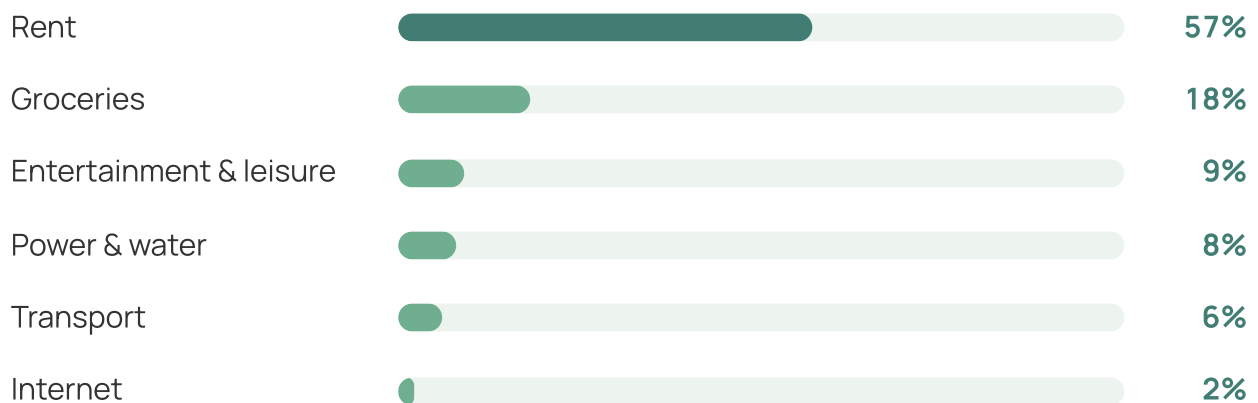
What it costs to live here

Brisbane's long-standing appeal still holds: big-city careers and sunshine, with housing that stays clearly below Sydney and Melbourne.

Housing is the line that decides it. Brisbane has seen strong price growth in recent years, so it is no longer the bargain it was a decade ago, but a family house in a genuine inner-ring suburb, within half an hour of tertiary work, remains an achievable plan on a clinical salary. That is the sentence that has become hard to write about Sydney.

We deliberately do not print prices, because figures date quickly. Use the live calculators in the directory at the back of this guide to compare Brisbane with the city you are leaving; that is the comparison that really counts.

Where a month goes



Proportions for one person on a mid-range budget, not amounts. Rent is the biggest line, and still below Sydney.

The costs to plan for

- ✓ Summer cooling. A few months of air conditioning shows up on the power bill; shade, fans and cross-breezes bring it down, and there is no winter heating bill to speak of.
- ✓ Home and contents insurance. Storm and flood cover costs more in Queensland than in the southern states, so get a quote for the specific address early.
- ✓ A car, and a toll account. Unless you live on a rail, busway or ferry route, most households run a car, and Brisbane's tunnels and motorways include toll roads.
- ✓ The move itself. A bond of up to four weeks' rent plus up to two weeks in advance, temporary accommodation and setting up a home.



Verandahs, shade and a garden: the kind of home that makes the most of Queensland living

IN SHORT

- ✓ On a clinical salary you can live very comfortably, and buying a family home is a realistic plan.
- ✓ Choose a cool, well-ventilated house and stay near a transport spine, and the summer and transport lines stay modest.
- ✓ Ask payroll about salary packaging on day one; many public and not-for-profit roles offer it, and it makes a real difference.



SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

What I tell people about Brisbane

Brisbane is the easiest Australian city for me to recommend to a family, and the one candidates most often underestimate. They arrive expecting a stepping stone to Sydney, then discover they can buy a house, keep the tertiary work, and be at the bay or in the rainforest by ten on a Saturday morning.

My one tip is to visit in February if you can, not just in July. If you enjoy the warm, stormy summer, the rest of the year is pure pleasure: blue winter days, outdoor living and the beach an hour away in either direction. The people who settle best plan their year around the sunshine, and most of them stop talking about moving south within a year or two.

Sophie Careem

Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing



Sunset over Surfers Paradise on the Gold Coast, an hour from Brisbane

Food, coffee and the everyday

Brisbane runs on an early clock and eats outdoors. The city gets its living done in the morning, and its restaurants long ago worked out that a verandah beats a dining room for most of the year.

Saturday morning is the fixed point. The farmers' markets at the Powerhouse in New Farm, the big West End market under the fig trees at Davies Park, and the growers' markets around the city all trade early and wind down by lunch. Buy fruit you have never seen before: the subtropics grow mangoes, lychees, custard apples and finger limes that the southern states can only import.

West End is the heart of the food scene, with Greek cafés since the fifties, Vietnamese since the seventies and now a strip of small bars and restaurants. Fortitude Valley and its Chinatown carry the late nights and live music; James Street is the polished end; Bulimba's Oxford Street and Paddington's Given Terrace are the neighbourhood versions.



Breakfast is the meal Brisbane does best



Long, shared lunches outdoors

The social calendar

- ✓ The Ekka, the Royal Queensland Show, every August, with a public holiday for Brisbane.
- ✓ Brisbane Festival and Riverfire fireworks over the river in September.
- ✓ Night markets, outdoor cinema and winter football that fills the stadium.
- ✓ Diwali, Onam, Lunar New Year and many more community festivals across the year.

NO DAYLIGHT SAVING

Everything is early

Gyms, swims, dog parks, parkrun and coffee queues all happen at an hour that surprises newcomers. You will soon love it.

EAT OUTSIDE

The verandah rule

Almost every good venue is open-sided. Book the outside table year-round, and watch a summer storm roll in from under the awning.

WELL SERVED

Flavours of home

Asian grocers around Sunnybank and Inala, halal butchers and African and Middle Eastern stores in the south and west, Indian and Sri Lankan grocers in the growth corridors.

EASY

Everyday shopping

Woolworths, Coles and ALDI everywhere, IGA locals, and independent grocers and butchers on the suburban high streets.

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Finding your people

Brisbane is a genuinely multicultural city, with large Indian, Filipino, Chinese, Vietnamese, African, Pacific and British communities, and Logan, just south, one of the most diverse cities in Australia. There are Malayali associations and Syro-Malabar parishes, gurdwaras, temples and mosques; the directory at the back of this guide lists where to start.



Flavours of home: Indian and Sri Lankan grocers are spread through the suburbs



Sunnybank, in the south, is the destination for Asian food and groceries

What people do at the weekend

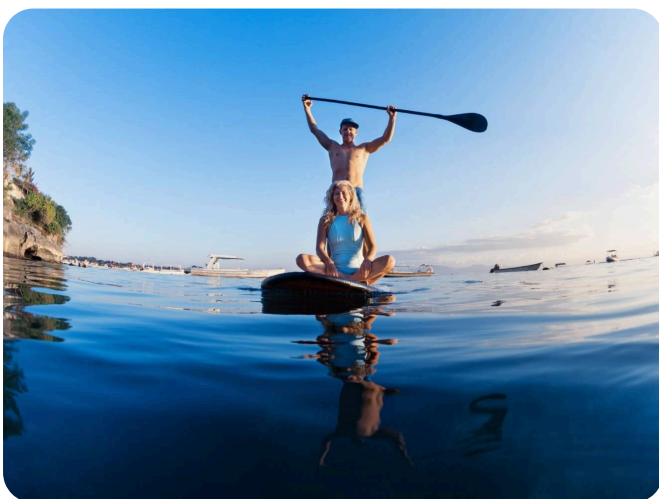
Brisbane's weekend geography is wonderfully generous: a bay full of sand islands to the east, rainforest in the ranges to the west and south, and the river and parks right in the middle of the city.

Closest to home, weekends start in the city itself. A morning swim in the South Bank lagoon or a climb at the Kangaroo Point cliffs, a CityCat the length of the river, sunset from Mount Coot-tha with the botanic gardens below it, or a visit to the koalas at Lone Pine.

Then there is the bay. Moreton Bay is the thing visitors miss and residents organise their lives around: Moreton Island (Mulgumpin) and North Stradbroke Island (Minjerribah) are both reachable by ferry for a day trip, and the bayside suburbs give you esplanades, mangrove boardwalks and fish and chips without the ferry.

A typical Brisbane weekend

- ✓ Saturday market before nine at New Farm, West End or Rocklea, then breakfast on a verandah.
- ✓ The bayside esplanades at Wynnum and Manly, or a ferry to Moreton or Stradbroke for snorkelling, dunes and dolphins.
- ✓ A swim at the South Bank lagoon, a walk up Mount Coot-tha or a ride along the river paths.
- ✓ In winter, rainforest walking in the Scenic Rim; in summer, the beach on either coast.



Stand-up paddleboarding on calm water



Camping weekends in national parks and on the islands

~15 MIN

Mount Coot-tha

Bush tracks, the botanic gardens and the city's favourite sunset lookout.

IN THE CITY

South Bank & the river

A free lagoon-style pool, gardens, the state gallery and museum, and the Riverwalk.

~30 MIN

Wynnum & Manly

Bayside esplanades, sailing, a farmers' market and fish and chips by the water.

FERRY FROM THE CITY'S EDGE

Moreton Island (Mulgumpin)

Clear water, shipwrecks to snorkel, sand dunes and dolphins: one of the great day trips.

FERRY FROM CLEVELAND

North Stradbroke (Minjerribah)

Surf beaches, the Gorge Walk and whales passing close to the headlands from June.

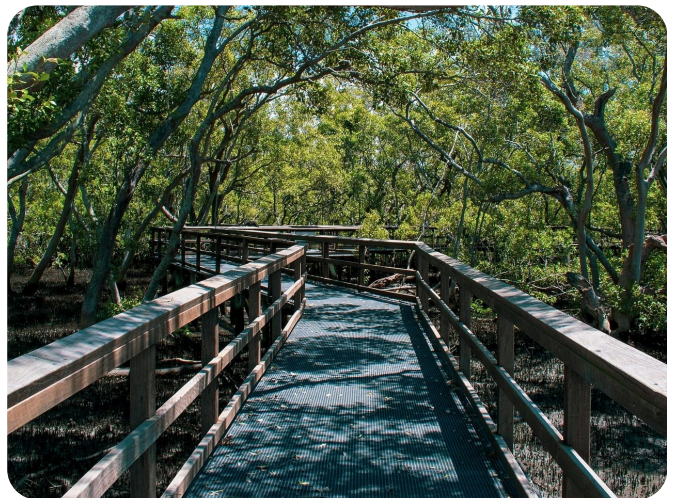
~1.5 HRS

Lamington & Springbrook

World Heritage Gondwana rainforest, waterfalls and treetop walks in the Scenic Rim.



Tangalooma on Moreton Island (Mulgumpin), a ferry ride across the bay



Mangrove boardwalks on Brisbane's bayside: shade and birdlife close to home

Around Brisbane

Few cities have so much within an easy drive: the Gold Coast and the Sunshine Coast, the islands of Moreton Bay, the Glass House Mountains and hinterland villages, and the garden city of Toowoomba on the range.

South is the Gold Coast: high-rises, a long surf strip, theme parks and some of the most famous beaches in the country, an hour away by train or road. North is the Sunshine Coast: lower-rise and green, with surf towns, Australia Zoo, and Noosa's national park headland at its northern end. Brisbane people are loyal to one or the other; try both before you take sides.

Inland, the Glass House Mountains rise out of the plain on the way north, and the Sunshine Coast hinterland villages of Maleny and Montville make a lovely weekend away. West, Toowoomba sits on the Great Dividing Range, cooler and famous for its gardens and spring flower festival. For snow, Queenslanders hop on a short flight south: the Victorian Alps and the New South Wales Snowy Mountains are an easy winter break.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
The nearest beaches	40 min – 1 hr	Bay beaches at Redcliffe and Bribie Island, or the surf beaches of the Gold and Sunshine Coasts about an hour away. Swim between the flags.
Ski fields (Victorian Alps or Snowy Mountains)	a short flight south	Fly to Melbourne, Sydney or Canberra and drive on; a classic winter holiday from June to September, snow permitting.
Gold Coast	~1 hr	Australia's sixth-largest city: surf, theme parks, the light rail along the beachfront and the hinterland behind.
Brisbane Airport	~20 min	Direct flights across Australia, Asia and the Pacific; Sydney is about 90 minutes away by air.
Sunshine Coast & Noosa	1 hr 15 – 2 hrs	Surf towns, Australia Zoo, the Noosa coastal walk and Hastings Street.
Glass House Mountains & Maleny	~1 hr – 1 hr 30	Volcanic peaks, lookouts and ridge-top villages with cheese, cafés and views to the sea.
Moreton & North Stradbroke Islands	ferry day trips	Sand islands with snorkelling, dunes, dolphins and whale-watching in winter.
Toowoomba	~2 hrs	A garden city on the range, cooler in summer, with the Carnival of Flowers each September.



The Gold Coast, an hour south: one of the great beach cities of the world

~1 HR · GOLD COAST

Burleigh Heads

A headland national park, a famous point break and a beachfront picnic spot with views up the coast.

~2 HRS · SUNSHINE COAST

Noosa

The national park coastal track, then breakfast on Hastings Street. A favourite long weekend.

~1 HR · SUNSHINE COAST

Australia Zoo

A big day out with children, close to the Glass House Mountains.

~1 HR 30

Springbrook

Waterfalls, rainforest walks and, after dark, glow-worms.

~2 HRS · NEW SOUTH WALES

Byron Bay

Lighthouse walks, surf and a relaxed coastal town over the border.

~2 HRS

Toowoomba

Grand old homes, parks and gardens, and cool, crisp winter mornings on the range.



Sunrise at Nobby Beach on the Gold Coast



Surfing on the Gold Coast, an hour from the city



Tallebudgera Creek on the southern Gold Coast, calm water beside the surf



A classic timber home in Toowoomba, the garden city on the range

Families and schools

Brisbane is one of Australia's great family cities: outdoor all year, safe and green, with good schools, sport everywhere and the beach within an hour.



Learning to surf: weekend lessons on the coast are a rite of passage



Calm creek mouths an easy drive from the city are ideal for little swimmers

Queensland schooling starts with Prep, a full-time year that children begin when they turn five by 30 June. Primary school runs from Prep to Year 6 and secondary school from Year 7 to Year 12, across four terms a year, finishing with the Queensland Certificate of Education (QCE).

Around two-thirds of children attend state schools, run by the Queensland Department of Education. Alongside them are Catholic schools and independent schools, many of them faith-based, which charge fees. Long-established state secondary schools such as Brisbane State High School sit alongside a wide choice of Catholic and independent colleges across the city.

State schools have catchment areas, and schools near capacity run enrolment management plans, so living in the catchment guarantees a place at your local school. Check the catchment for the exact address before you sign a lease.

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School fees for temporary visa holders

Queensland generally enrolls the children of skilled employer-sponsored visa holders (such as the 482 and 494) in state schools without tuition fees, while some other temporary visas are fee-paying. Confirm your visa subclass with the Department of Education's international unit (DE International), which publishes the schedule of visa subclasses and enrolment conditions. School levies, uniforms and excursions still apply.

What children tend to love here

- ✓ The South Bank lagoon and Streets Beach, a free city-centre swim.
- ✓ The Queensland Museum and the children's programmes at the Queensland Art Gallery and State Library.
- ✓ Learning to swim early, at school and at the local pool.
- ✓ Lone Pine Koala Sanctuary and the koalas at Daisy Hill.
- ✓ Nippers (junior surf lifesaving) on the coasts, and club sport from football and netball to swimming and cricket.
- ✓ Ferry rides, playgrounds and riverside parks across the city.



After the bell: outdoor learning and play suit the climate



Koalas in a eucalypt: a favourite with visiting families

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Early childhood

Queensland funds free kindy, up to 15 hours a week, in approved kindergarten programmes in the year before Prep. Long day care and family day care are widely available; many families on temporary visas are not eligible for the federal Child Care Subsidy, so ask about fees and waitlists early.

ST LUCIA

University of Queensland

One of Australia's leading research universities, on a riverside campus with major health and medical research.

GARDENS POINT & KELVIN GROVE

QUT

A large city university known for health, nursing, engineering and creative industries.

NATHAN, MT GRAVATT & THE GOLD COAST

Griffith University

A big multi-campus university with strong health and nursing programmes.

ACROSS THE CITY

TAFE Queensland

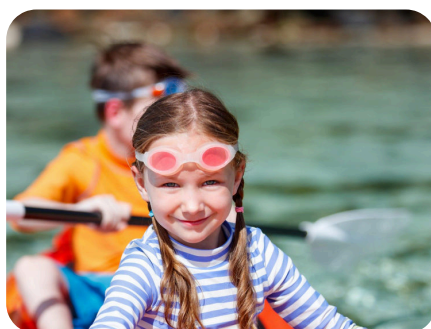
Vocational training and English courses, including pathways into health and community services.



Rainbow Bay at Coolangatta on the Gold Coast: a sheltered, family-friendly beach



Early learning: kindy in the year before Prep



Water confidence starts young here



Outdoor play in a leafy preschool garden

“

Come for the work and the winter; stay for the life the river city makes room for.

Your Brisbane address book

Brisbane is a genuinely multicultural city, and Logan on its southern side is one of the most diverse places in Australia. The Malayali community has its own state association and three Syro-Malabar and Knanaya Catholic communities across the city, and you will find established Nigerian, wider African, Sri Lankan, Filipino and Chinese communities alongside gurdwaras, temples, mosques and a synagogue that has served the city since 1865.

COUNCILS & LOCAL SERVICES

Brisbane City Council

Rubbish, libraries, parks, pools, pet registration, events and the FloodWise property reports and flood maps

07 3403 8888 brisbane.qld.gov.au

Logan City Council

Logan, the fast-growing city on Brisbane's southern side

logan.qld.gov.au

City of Moreton Bay

The northern suburbs and the corridor towards the Sunshine Coast

moretonbay.qld.gov.au

Ipswich City Council

Ipswich and the western growth area

ipswich.qld.gov.au

GETTING AROUND & HEALTH ADVICE

Translink

Trains, buses, ferries and trams across south-east Queensland, the go card and the journey planner

13 12 30 translink.com.au

13 HEALTH

Queensland's 24/7 health advice line, staffed by registered nurses

13 43 25 84 qld.gov.au/health

Queensland Government

Driver licences, vehicle registration, schools and state services in one place

qld.gov.au

COMMUNITY & CULTURAL ASSOCIATIONS

Malayalee Association of Queensland (MAQ)

Kerala cultural association for Brisbane and Queensland: Onam, Christmas and Kerala festivals, sports events and social gatherings through the year.

facebook.com/MalayaleeAssociationofQueensland

Nigerian Community Association Queensland

Nigerian community group with networking events, family picnics, sports days and social events, and branches on the Gold Coast and in Toowoomba.

nigeriansinqld.org.au

Queensland African Communities Council

Umbrella body for African communities in Queensland: cultural dinners, a community garden, sport, music and dance, based at the African Village in Moorooka.

facebook.com/qacc.AU

Federation of Sri Lanka Organisations of Queensland (FSOQ)

Umbrella body for Sri Lankan community organisations in Queensland; a good first contact for cultural and community events.

Multicultural Australia

Brisbane-based settlement organisation: help with housing, employment pathways, skills and community connection for new arrivals.

multiculturalaustralia.org.au

Ethnic Communities Council of Queensland (ECCQ)

Peak body for multicultural communities since 1976, with community programmes, multicultural health services and aged care.

eccq.com.au

Filipino Catholic Community, Archdiocese of Brisbane

Filipino-community Masses on set weekends at parishes in Acacia Ridge, Zillmere, Caboolture, Ipswich and Southport; a warm way to meet Filipino families.

multiculturalcare.org.au/diversity/filipino-catholic-community

PLACES OF WORSHIP

Cathedral of St Stephen (Catholic)

The Catholic cathedral of the Archdiocese of Brisbane, in the city centre; the archdiocese website has a parish finder.

cathedralofststephen.org.au

St Thomas the Apostle Syro-Malabar Forane Church

Syro-Malabar Catholic parish for Brisbane South, with daily and weekend Masses in Malayalam. 108–112 Middle Road, Hillcrest.

stthomasforanebne.org

St Alphonsa Syro-Malabar Catholic Parish

Syro-Malabar Catholic parish for Brisbane North. 688 Nudgee Road, Northgate.

stalphonsaparishbrisbane.org.au

Holy Family Knanaya Catholic Mission, Brisbane

Knanaya Catholic community in Brisbane, listed by the Syro-Malabar Eparchy of Melbourne.

syromalabar.org.au

St John's Cathedral (Anglican)

The Anglican cathedral of Brisbane, at 373 Ann Street in the city centre.

stjohnscathedral.com.au

Citipointe Church (Pentecostal)

Large Pentecostal church with campuses across Brisbane, including Brisbane West, Ipswich, Pine Rivers, Redcliffe and Caboolture.

citipointechurch.com

Holland Park Mosque (Islamic Society of Holland Park)

Brisbane's best-known mosque, serving the community since 1908, with daily prayers and community activities.

hollandparkmosque.org.au

Kuraby Mosque

Community mosque in Brisbane's south at 1408 Beenleigh Road, Kuraby.

Sri Selva Vinayakar Koyil (Hindu)

South Indian-style temple dedicated to Lord Ganesha, at 4915–4923 Mt Lindesay Highway, South Maclean.

siselvavinayakar.org

Brisbane Sikh Temple (Gurdwara)

The city's main gurdwara, at 2679 Logan Road, Eight Mile Plains.

brisbanesikh temple.org.au

Fo Guang Shan Chung Tian Temple (Buddhist)

Buddhist temple and cultural centre with gardens, at 1034 Underwood Road, Priestdale.

fgschungtian.org.au

Brisbane Hebrew Congregation

Traditional, inclusive Orthodox synagogue in the city centre, serving Queensland's Jewish community since 1865.

brisbanehebrewcongregation.com

HALAL, KOSHER & INTERNATIONAL GROCERIES

Sunnybank Plaza

Shopping centre 12 km south of the city, known as Brisbane's home of authentic Asian eats, with Asian grocers and restaurants around it.

sunnybankplaza.com.au

Sunnybank, Inala and Kuraby

The south side's grocery belt: Asian supermarkets around Sunnybank and Inala, and halal butchers and international grocers around Kuraby and the southern suburbs.

SUPERMARKETS & MARKETS

Woolworths

National supermarket chain with stores across Brisbane; online ordering and delivery.

[woolworths.com.au](https://www.woolworths.com.au)

Coles

National supermarket chain with stores across Brisbane; online ordering and delivery.

[coles.com.au](https://www.coles.com.au)

ALDI

Discount supermarket, popular for the weekly basket.

[aldi.com.au](https://www.aldi.com.au)

Jan Powers Farmers Markets

Farmers' markets at the Brisbane Powerhouse in New Farm (every Saturday), Manly Harbour (first and third Saturdays) and Eagle Farm Racecourse (Sundays).

[janpowersfarmersmarkets.com.au](https://www.janpowersfarmersmarkets.com.au)

West End Markets, Davies Park

Over 150 stalls of produce, food, fashion and crafts under the fig trees in West End, every Saturday from 6am.

[goodwillprojects.com.au/markets/west-end](https://www.goodwillprojects.com.au/markets/west-end)

Saturday Fresh Market, Brisbane Markets Rocklea

The city's wholesale market opens to the public every Saturday from 6am to noon, at 385 Sherwood Road, Rocklea.

[brisbanemarkets.com.au](https://www.brisbanemarkets.com.au)

SCHOOLS & UNIFORMS

Queensland Schools Directory

Find state schools by name, suburb, region and type, with links to each school's website and catchment information.

schoolsdirectory.eq.edu.au

DE International (Queensland Department of Education)

Enrolment rules and fees for children of temporary visa holders at Queensland state schools; check your visa subclass here before you enrol.

[education.qld.gov.au](https://www.education.qld.gov.au)

School uniforms

Most Queensland state schools sell uniforms through their own uniform shop, often run by the school's P&C association; the school will tell you its opening hours and whether second-hand uniforms are available.

HOUSING & AREAS

realestate.com.au

Rentals and homes for sale across Brisbane.

[realestate.com.au](https://www.realestate.com.au)

Domain

Rentals and homes for sale across Brisbane.

[domain.com.au](https://www.domain.com.au)

Flatmates.com.au

Rooms and house-shares, useful for the first few months.

[flatmates.com.au](https://www.flatmates.com.au)

Residential Tenancies Authority (RTA)

Queensland's renting authority: holds rental bonds and runs a free dispute resolution service.

[rta.qld.gov.au](https://www.rta.qld.gov.au)

Tenants Queensland

Free statewide tenancy advice and advocacy for renters.

1300 744 263 [tenantsqld.org.au](https://www.tenantsqld.org.au)

Brisbane City Council FloodWise

Free flood maps and property reports for any Brisbane address; worth checking before you sign.

[brisbane.qld.gov.au](https://www.brisbane.qld.gov.au)

GETTING AROUND

Translink

Trains, buses, ferries and trams across south-east Queensland: the go card, contactless payment, fares and the journey planner.

13 12 30 [translink.com.au](https://www.translink.com.au)

Linkt

Toll account for Brisbane's motorways and tunnels, including the airport link.

linkt.com.au

Queensland Government: overseas and interstate licences

How to drive on, and transfer, an overseas licence in Queensland (Department of Transport and Main Roads).

qld.gov.au/transport/licensing/driver-licensing/overseas

COST COMPARISON LINKS

Numbeo: Brisbane

Crowd-sourced cost-of-living data; compare Brisbane with the city you are leaving.

numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Brisbane

Expatistan

A second side-by-side cost-of-living comparison.

expatistan.com

Australian Bureau of Statistics

Official figures on prices, rents and household spending.

abs.gov.au



Checked October 2026

Community groups, shops and pages change. If a link has moved or you know a group we should add, tell us and we will update the guide.

Numbers and websites to keep handy

The national services every newcomer uses, wherever in Australia you land.

EMERGENCIES & HEALTH ADVICE

Emergency services

Police, fire and ambulance, any time
000

Emergency from a mobile

Also connects to emergency services from any mobile phone
112

healthdirect

Free 24/7 health advice from a registered nurse
1800 022 222 [healthdirect.gov.au](https://www.healthdirect.gov.au)

Lifeline

24/7 crisis support and suicide prevention, by phone, text or chat
13 11 14 [lifeline.org.au](https://www.lifeline.org.au)

Poisons Information Centre

24/7 advice if someone may have been poisoned
13 11 26

Pregnancy, Birth and Baby

Free support for parents from pregnancy to preschool
1800 882 436 [pregnancybirthbaby.org.au](https://www.pregnancybirthbaby.org.au)

Private health insurance complaints

The Commonwealth Ombudsman's free complaints service
1300 737 299 [ombudsman.gov.au](https://www.ombudsman.gov.au)

VISAS, REGISTRATION & WORK

Department of Home Affairs

Visas, skilled occupation lists and processing times
immi.homeaffairs.gov.au

ImmiAccount

Lodge and track your visa application online
online.immi.gov.au

Register of migration agents (OMARA)

Check an agent is registered before you pay
mara.gov.au

Ahpra

National registration and the National Boards
1300 419 495 ahpra.gov.au

Fair Work Ombudsman

Awards, pay rates and your rights at work
13 13 94 [fairwork.gov.au](https://www.fairwork.gov.au)

HEALTHCARE FOR YOUR FAMILY

Medicare · Services Australia

Enrolment, cards, claims and reciprocal health care agreements
132 011 [servicesaustralia.gov.au/medicare](https://www.servicesaustralia.gov.au/medicare)

healthdirect service finder

Find a GP, pharmacy, urgent care or hospital near you
[healthdirect.gov.au/australian-health-services](https://www.healthdirect.gov.au/australian-health-services)

privatehealth.gov.au

Compare private health cover independently; run by the Commonwealth Ombudsman
[privatehealth.gov.au](https://www.privatehealth.gov.au)

SCHOOLS & CHILDCARE

NSW school finder

Government schools and catchments in New South Wales
[education.nsw.gov.au/school-finder](https://www.education.nsw.gov.au/school-finder)

Find my school (Victoria)

School zones for any Victorian address
[findmyschool.vic.gov.au](https://www.findmyschool.vic.gov.au)

Find a school (Queensland)

State schools and catchment areas
qld.gov.au/education/schools/find

Find a public school (WA)

Western Australian public schools and local-intake areas
wa.gov.au/service/education-and-training/school-education/find-public-school

School zones (South Australia)

Zone maps for government schools
education.sa.gov.au/parents-and-families/enrol-school-or-preschool/zones-catchments-and-capacity-management/maps-school-zones-enrolment-year

Find your local school (Tasmania)

Intake areas for Tasmanian government schools
decyp.tas.gov.au/learning/find-your-local-school

Priority enrolment areas (ACT)

Find a Canberra public school for your address
act.gov.au/education-and-training/find-a-school-and-enrol

Choose a school (NT)

Urban and remote schools in the Northern Territory
nt.gov.au/learning/primary-and-secondary-students/choose-a-school

Starting Blocks

Compare childcare services and quality ratings near you
startingblocks.gov.au

Child Care Subsidy

Eligibility, rates and how to apply
servicesaustralia.gov.au/child-care-subsidy

MONEY & HOME

Australian Taxation Office

Apply for your tax file number (TFN), tax and super
13 28 61 ato.gov.au

Moneysmart

Free, independent budgeting, super and banking tools
moneysmart.gov.au

SETTLING IN

TIS National

Free interpreting by phone, 24/7, in 150+ languages
131 450 tisnational.gov.au

Settle in Australia

Home Affairs' settlement topics and services for new arrivals
immi.homeaffairs.gov.au/settling-in-australia

MyAus app

Government app to help newcomers find services, in many languages
myausapp.com

Overseas drivers (Austroads)

How overseas licences are recognised, with links to each state's licensing authority
austroads.gov.au/drivers-and-vehicles/overseas-drivers/country-recognition



Always check the source

Rules, fees and services change. Treat these as starting points and confirm details with the organisation. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not registered migration agents.

Six steps, and someone beside you for each one

Moving country is a sequence of decisions. We take them with you in order, so you are never solving step five before step two is done.



STEP 1

Discovery call

A relaxed conversation about your profession, your family and what you want from a move. No forms, no pressure.



STEP 2

Eligibility & registration

We map your route to Ahpra registration and help you gather the evidence the regulator will ask for.



STEP 3

Opportunities & interviews

Roles matched to where you want to live and how you like to work, with honest briefings before every interview.



STEP 4

Offer & decision support

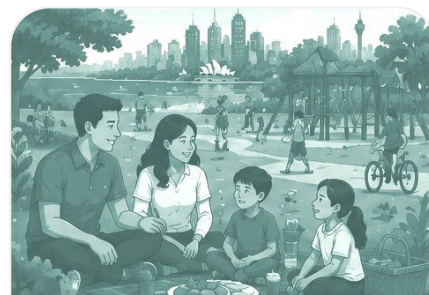
We help you read the offer properly: pay step, relocation support, roster and what the team is really like.



STEP 5

Visa & relocation guidance

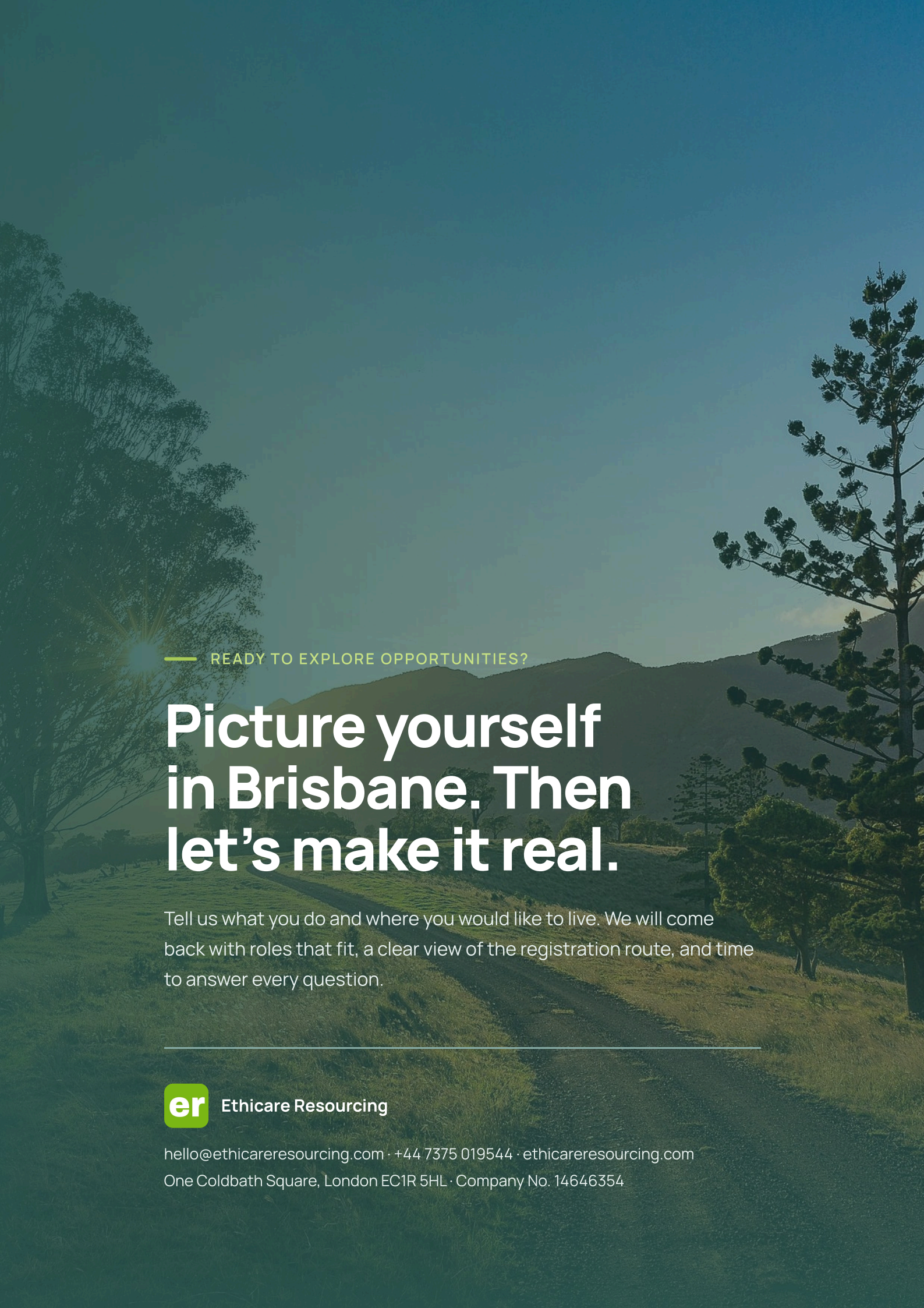
Practical guidance on visas, shipping, pets, schools and the first weeks, so nothing arrives as a surprise.



STEP 6

Settling in

We stay in touch after you land, from your first week on the ward to your first winter.



— READY TO EXPLORE OPPORTUNITIES?

Picture yourself in Brisbane. Then let's make it real.

Tell us what you do and where you would like to live. We will come back with roles that fit, a clear view of the registration route, and time to answer every question.



Ethicare Resourcing

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